

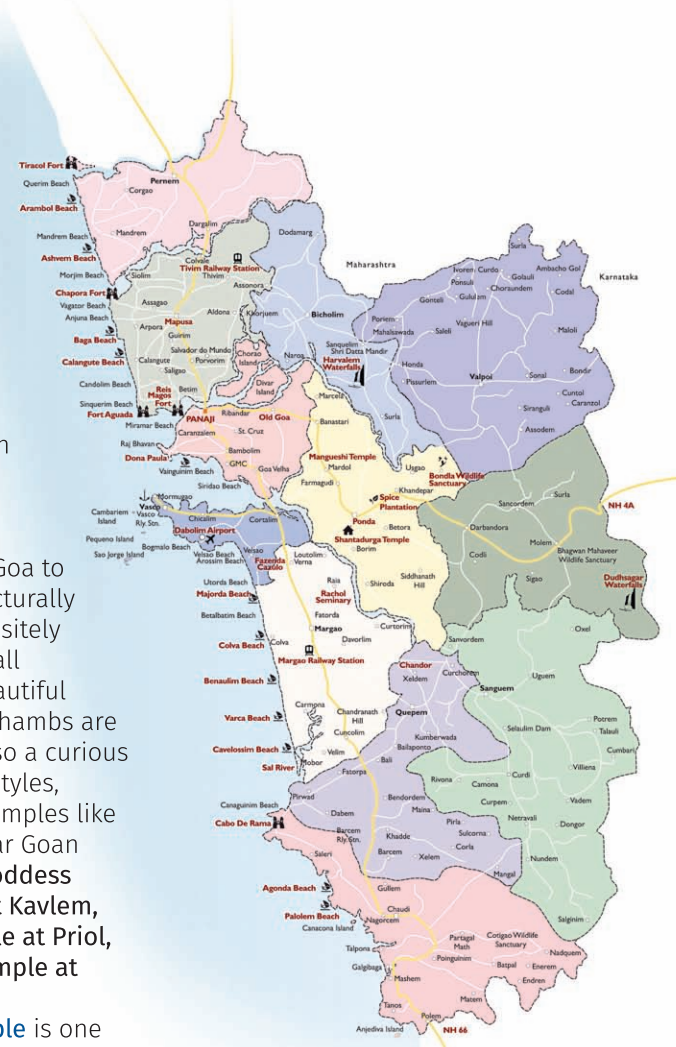
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TOURISM IN GOA

Goa – the name conjures up serene images of sun-kissed beaches with silver sands, golden sunsets and swaying palms. And why not? After all, the entire western boundary of Goa is one long beach - 105 kilometers in length, broken only by the rivers as they meet the Arabian Sea. But a point to note: though Goa's claim to fame is rooted in its beaches, the state is gradually opening up her treasure trove, revealing her well-guarded secrets! Let's explore what other wonders the state has to offer:

GLOWING WAVES

If you've ever visited Goa, you've certainly heard the names of some of its famous beaches which are by far the most popular tourist destination in the state. These include beaches in **Calangute, Baga, Vagator** and **Anjuna** in the North, **Miramar** and **Dona Paula** beach near Panaji, and **Colva, Varca, Benaulim** and **Palolem** in the South. However, a less-known fact about the Goan coast is that if you're lucky, you can watch the waves come alive, illuminated with a myriad glow. Numerous beachgoers from across both North and South Goa claim to have been relaxing at the beach when they witnessed waves break in brilliant neon blue and green colours. This phenomenon can be attributed to microscopic bioluminescent plankton that appear at the beaches in large numbers when the conditions are just right. Visitors have the best chance to witness this phenomenon during the winter months, especially at beaches like Betalbatim in South Goa.



FEED THE SPIRIT

Many visitors come to Goa to experience her architecturally rich temples with exquisitely sculpted stone icons, tall deep-sthambs, and beautiful reservoirs. The deep-sthambs are light towers and are also a curious blend of architectural styles, standing outside the temples like giant guardians. Popular Goan Temples include the **Goddess Shantadurga temple at Kavlem, Shree Manguesh temple at Priol, and Shree Naguesh temple at Bandora.**

The Tambdi Surla Temple is one of the lesser-known, yet, most interesting temples you can visit in Goa. It is the best-preserved temple of the Kadamba era and is located at Tambdi Surla in Sanguem taluka 65 kilometres from Panaji. It was built between the 12th and 13th centuries of black schist. Though only a part of the shikhara (spire) is standing, it is adorned with intricate stone motifs depicting Brahma, Vishnu, Shiva and his consort Parvati which immediately